



# The Power of X-Rays



Have you had an x-ray before? Do you know the history of x-rays? What is an x-ray and when were x-rays discovered? X-rays are useful things. X-rays can show us pictures of the insides of objects. They can go through something that light cannot.

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X-rays were discovered as far back as 1895 by the physicist Wilhelm Conrad Röntgen. He found that x-rays could be photographed as they pass through the human body. The first x-ray he took was of his wife's hand.

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X-rays are powerful light waves that carry a lot of energy. X-rays are a form of electromagnetic radiation. When radiation passes as light through the body and onto a photographic plate, we can see images of our bones and organs.

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An x-ray machine works by directing x-rays towards an object. The x-rays pass through some parts of the object, like the skin and muscle, and are blocked by other hard parts, such as bones. We can see the hard parts as white.

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X-rays can show us signs of injury inside our bodies. Doctors can find broken bones. Dentists can look at cavities in teeth.

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Radiation from x-rays can have side-effects on the body. In the early days, scientists and doctors did not know that too much radiation exposure could make people unwell. Today, modern methods of taking x-rays are very safe.

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X-rays are also used for non-medical uses. At airports, our luggage is scanned with x-ray machines. X-rays are used in space research with telescopes to pick up the x-rays given off by stars and asteroids. As you can see, the discovery of x-rays was brilliant. This is the power of x-rays.

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